

Pornography

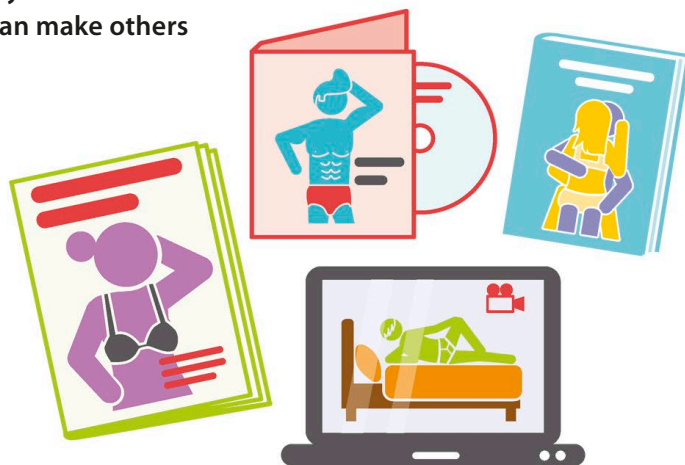
Often shortened to “porn” or “porno,” pornography is sexual media intended to arouse the person using it. It includes videos, photos, writing, and video games that feature sexual activity or sexual images. Some people watch porn regularly, but it can make others feel very uncomfortable.

What is pornography?

Images of nudity have been created throughout human history, as a form of artistic expression or occasionally to arouse the person engaging with it. Pornography tends to show naked or seminaked adults performing sexual acts. It's usually an explicit depiction of sex, and it's not typically done in an artistic way.

▷ Types of pornographic media

Pornographic media comes in many different forms, the most common being online videos, films, video games, and magazines.



SEE ALSO

◀ 198–199 Healthy relationships

◀ 216–217 Masturbation

◀ 220–221 Consent

◀ 224–225 Sex

Why people use it

Pornography is used by a range of people and for different reasons. People may use pornography by themselves, or with their partner if they are in a couple. Reasons for watching porn may include:

Exploring fantasies
and what a person finds arousing.

Assisting masturbation by
helping with arousal.

Watching it with a partner
as part of foreplay.

Is pornography okay?

There's a lot of debate about pornography. Some people take a positive view and believe that the actors enjoy their participation, and are involved by choice. They feel that pornography can help people to embrace their sexuality. Others argue that porn typically shows sexism, unsafe sex, exploitation, and violence. They feel that actors are exploited by the production companies. They also claim that some actors may have been sexually abused in the past and so might have distorted ideas about intimacy.



△ Personal choice

It's important to respect individual choice, but to be aware that all countries have laws about the content of pornography, and to only use porn that complies with those laws.